

ANNIE (CHENXI) ZHOU

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin, Madison, WI, U.S. Curriculum and Instruction Ph.D. Starting 09/2026

- **Concentration:** Design, Informal, and Creative Education (DICE)
- **Advisors:** Dr. Matthew Berland

University of Michigan (U-M), Ann Arbor, MI, U.S. Educational Studies M.A. 08/2024 – 12/2025

- **Concentration:** Design and Technologies for Learning Across Culture and Contexts
- **Advisors:** Dr. Chris Quintana and Dr. Rebecca Quintana
- **GPA:** 4.00 / 4.00

Tongji University, Shanghai, China | Design B.Eng. | Graduate with Honors 09/2016 – 07/2021

- **Concentration:** Environmental Design
- **Exchange program:** Service Design at the University of Navarra
- **WES-evaluated GPA:** 4.00 / 4.00 (equivalent to 4.69/5.00, top 2%)

EDUCATION RESEARCH & PRACTICE

GRIP Lab, Marsal Family School of Education, U-M | Research Assistant 01/2025 – Present

- **Syllabus Analysis:** Co-designed a coding scheme, led syllabus analysis, and conducted quantitative analyses to examine syllabus design variations and their relationships with students' learning gains.
- **Database Management:** Led the transfer, organization, and management of project data in a new database system.

Community Tech Consultants (CTC) Program, U-M | Curriculum Designer 03/2025 – Present

- **Curriculum Development:** Led the full design cycle of a community-based curriculum preparing college students as culturally responsive tech consultants, including literature review, data collection and analysis, evaluation, and iterative refinement.
- **Data Analysis and Writing:** Led qualitative analysis of prior training data, mentored undergraduate researchers in the coding process, and led the writing of a conference paper based on the findings.

Eileen Lappin Weiser Center for the Learning Sciences, U-M | Research Fellow 05/2025 – Present

- **Design-Based Research:** Conducted design-based research on the development of AI-produced instructor avatar videos to enhance learner engagement in online course discussions through iterative cycles of learner feedback analysis, design, testing, and refinement.
- **Scoping Review:** Led a scoping review and manuscript development on the use of generative AI instructor avatars in instructional videos.

Center for Academic Innovation, U-M | Learning Experience Designer 09/2024 – 04/2025

- **Course Development:** Supported syllabus planning and developed teaching and learning materials, such as slides, quizzes, and course summaries.
- **Course Deployment:** Supported the deployment and management of the online learning platform, helping ensure smooth course access, effective delivery, and an engaging learning experience.

Equitable Teaching Website, LSA, U-M | Digital Marketing Assistant 08/2024 – 05/2025

- **Culturally Responsive Teaching Research:** Conducted a systematic literature review and instructor interviews on culturally responsive teaching; wrote a blog post to inform inclusive teaching practices.
- **Outreach and Communications:** Managed the project website and created inclusive monthly newsletters to enhance accessibility, communication, and outreach.

ClassIn Educational Technology Co., Shanghai | Curriculum Designer 09/2023 – 02/2024

- **Curriculum Development:** Led the development of 10+ K–12 curricula implemented across schools in China, reaching over 1,850 students, with topics including AI, environmental education, and more.
- **Textbook Design:** Led the development of an upper-elementary environmental education textbook to cultivate students' environmental awareness through an experiential learning journey.

SCHOLARLY WRITING

Papers in Peer-reviewed Conference Proceedings

- **Zhou, A., Seefeldt, K., Hui, J., Bare, C., Sanifu, L., & Dillahunt, T. R. (2026).** A community-engaged curriculum design model for culturally responsive tech consulting. *Proceedings of the 20th International Conference of the Learning Sciences (ICLS 2026)*. Irvine, USA: International Society of the Learning Sciences.

Conference Presentations (Unpublished, peer-reviewed papers)

- **Zhou, A. (2026, April).** *Student Self-Positioning and the Development of Mathematical Competencies*. Roundtable session accepted for presentation at the Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association (AERA).
- **Quintana, R. M. & Zhou, A. (2026, April).** *Using affordance analysis to strategize the integration of AI-generated instructor avatars within MOOCs*. Poster session accepted for presentation at the Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association (AERA).

Public Scholarship

- **Zhou, A. (2025, June).** *Good teaching from a historical perspective: Culturally responsive teaching*. University of Michigan Library Student Stories Blog. <https://blogs.lib.umich.edu/student-stories/good-teaching-historical-perspective-culturally-responsive-teaching>
- **Zhou, A. (2025, February).** *Stories of culturally responsive teaching from frontline instructors*. Equitable Teaching Project, University of Michigan. <https://sites.lsa.umich.edu/equitable-teaching/stories-of-culturally-responsive-teaching-from-frontline-instructors/>

PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATION

- Quintana, R. M. & **Zhou, A.** (2026, February). Designing for Learner Engagement with Instructor Avatars in AI-Produced MOOC Videos [Presentation]. AI Institute for Adult Learning and Online Education. [Virtual].
- Silver, N., **Zhou, A.**, & Kebede, A. (2025, May). Designing an equitable syllabus [Conference presentation]. Enriching Scholarship Conference, University of Michigan. [Virtual].

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Peer Reviewer for Journals

- Research in Learning Technology 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teach For China (TFC), Nanning | Mathematics Teacher 07/2021 – 07/2023

- **Teaching:** Designed and gave math courses for 1-3rd graders, with class rankings remaining in the top 3 among 21 township schools.
- **Research:** Conducted research on the local learning ecosystem and studied how community resources can be leveraged to enhance learning and teaching.
- **Leadership:** Led the volunteer team in organizing diverse community activities to expand the impact of the TFC program, fostering stronger community involvement and outreach.

DESIGN & MANAGEMENT EXPERIENCE

BIGmind Innovative Service Organization, Shanghai | Designer Intern 08/2020 – 03/2021

- **User Experience Design:** Led user experience research and design through focus group discussions, expert panels, and workshops to inform design decisions and ensure alignment with project goals.
- **Media Design:** Co-designed a company website and developed inclusive, user-centered digital materials for diverse audiences across multiple projects.

UN-Habitat China, Beijing | Program Assistant Intern 05/2020 – 02/2021

- Designed visual materials—including annual reports, posters, and social media content—and assisted in planning and implementing workshops and conferences.

SKILLS

- **Tools:** Qualtrics, Microsoft suite, Google suite, Adobe suite, Figma
- **Qualitative research skills:** Design-Based Research, Survey Design, Portraiture Study, Ethnography
- **Quantitative research skills:** Cluster Analysis, Correlation Analysis

AWARDS

• Marsal Excellent Award, U-M \$11,166 per semester	2024-2025
• U-M Library Student Mini-Grant, U-M \$750	2025
• Excellent Teaching Quality Award, Nanning Municipal Bureau of Education	2021-2023
• Municipal Outstanding Program Teacher, TFC	2021-2022
• National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China ¥ 8,000	2018
• Tongji Scholarship of Excellence, Tongji University ¥ 3,000	2017

CERTIFICATION

• Community Engaged Course Design Workshop, University of Michigan	2026
• Learning Experience Design, University of Michigan	2025
• Generative AI: Fundamentals, Applications, and Challenges, Coursera	2024
• AI-Powered Data Analysis: A Practical Introduction, Coursera	2024
• How Science Turns Data Into Knowledge, Coursera	2024
• Social Work Practice: Advocating Social Justice and Change, Coursera	2024
• Teacher Qualification Certificate in Elementary School Mathematics, Ministry of Education China	2023

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

• American Educational Research Association (AERA) Member of Advanced Technologies for Learning SIG, Instructional Technology SIG, Research in Mathematics Education SIG
• International Society of the Learning Sciences (ISLS)